The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

15th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Indecision (दुविधा)

Meaning: The inability to make a decision quickly.
Synonyms: Hesitation, uncertainty, wavering
Antonyms: Determination, decisiveness, resolution
Example: His indecision about which course to take delayed his enrollment.

2. Flawless (निर्दोष)

Meaning: Without any imperfections or defects.
Synonyms: Perfect, impeccable, unblemished
Antonyms: Defective, imperfect, flawed
Example: Her singing performance was flawless and left the audience in awe.

VOCABULARY

3. Perceive (अनुभव करना/समझना)

Meaning: To become aware or conscious of something; to interpret or regard in a particular way.
Synonyms: Discern, recognize, detect
Antonyms: Ignore, overlook, disregard
Example: She could perceive the tension in the room as soon as she entered.

4. Defier (आज्ञा न मानने वाला)

Meaning: A person who resists or challenges authority or conventions.
Synonyms: Rebel, challenger, dissenter
Antonyms: Conformist, follower, adherent
Example: The defier openly questioned the management's decision during the meeting.

VOCABULARY

5. Impairment (क्षति)

Meaning: The state of being diminished or weakened, especially in strength or quality.
Synonyms: Weakness, damage, deterioration
Antonyms: Enhancement, improvement, strength
Example: His hearing impairment made communication challenging in noisy environments.

6. Relentless (निरंतर/अथक)

Meaning: Continuing without becoming weaker or less severe; determined.
Synonyms: Persistent, unyielding, unwavering
Antonyms: Intermittent, lenient, yielding
Example: The relentless efforts of the team ensured the project's success.

VOCABULARY

7. Parleys (वार्तालाप)

Meaning: Discussions or conferences between parties, especially to resolve a dispute.
Synonyms: Negotiations, talks, discussions
Antonyms: Silence, conflict, confrontation
Example: The leaders held parleys to address the ongoing trade disputes.

8. Acrimonious (तीखा, कटु)

Meaning: Angry and bitter, especially in speech or debate.
Synonyms: Hostile, bitter, harsh
Antonyms: Amicable, friendly, mild
Example: The debate turned acrimonious as the candidates began attacking each other's past decisions.

VOCABULARY

9. Annihilation (विनाश)

Meaning: Complete destruction or obliteration.
Synonyms: Destruction, obliteration, eradication
Antonyms: Preservation, creation
Example: The fear of annihilation loomed large over the nations during the cold war.

10. Endeavor (प्रयास)

Meaning: An attempt to achieve a goal.
Synonyms: Effort, attempt, venture
Antonyms: Inaction, negligence
Example: The scientist's endeavor to find a cure for the disease was commendable.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Hold up:
Meaning: To delay or obstruct

2. Knock back:
Meaning: To consume quickly, especially a drink, or to cost someone a specific amount

3. Pan out:
Meaning: To turn out or result in a particular way, often successfully

4. Rope in:
Meaning: To persuade or enlist someone to participate in an activity or task

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. Chance one's arm

Meaning: To take a risk in the hope of achieving success.

2. Dead in the water

Meaning: Completely stalled or unable to progress.

3. Hit the nail on the head

Meaning: To describe or do something exactly right.

VOCABULARY

4. Sink or swim

Meaning: To succeed or fail entirely by one's own efforts.

5. Works like a charm

Meaning: Functions perfectly or produces the desired results effortlessly.

Article for Reading

Why happiness is healthy

You might call it a sense of well-being, of optimism or of meaningfulness in life, although those could also be treated as separate entities. But whatever happiness is, we know that we want it, and that is just somehow good. We also know that we don't always have control over our happiness. Research suggests that genetics may play a big role in our normal level of subjective well-being, so some of us may start out at a disadvantage. On top of that, between unexpected tragedies and daily habitual stress, environmental factors can bring down mood and dry up our thirst for living. Being able to manage the emotional ups and downs is important for both body and mind, said Laura Kubzansky, professor of social and behavioral sciences at Harvard School of Public Health. "For physical health, it's not so much happiness per se, but this ability to regulate and have a sense of purpose and meaning," Kubzansky said. Many scientific studies, including some by Kubzansky, have found a connection between psychological and physical well-being.

A 2012 review of more than 200 studies found a connection between positive psychological attributes, such as happiness, optimism and life satisfaction, and a lowered risk of cardiovascular disease. Kubzansky and other Harvard School of Public Health researchers published these findings in the journal Psychological Bulletin. It's not as simple as "you must be happy to prevent heart attacks," of course. If you have a good sense of well-being, it's easier to maintain good habits: Exercising, eating a balanced diet and getting enough sleep, researchers said. People who have an optimistic mindset may be more likely to engage in healthy behaviors because they perceive them as helpful in achieving their goals, Kubzansky said. Lower blood pressure, normal body weight and healthier blood fat profiles were also associated with a better sense of well-being in this study. For now these studies can only show associations; they do not provide hard evidence of cause and effect. But some researchers speculate that positive mental states do have a direct effect on the body, perhaps by reducing damaging physical processes.

For instance, another of Kubzansky's studies found that optimism is associated with lower levels of inflammation. If what you mean by happiness is specifically "enjoyment of life," there's newer evidence to support that, too. A study in the Canadian Medical Association Journal found that people ages 60 and older who said they enjoyed life less were more likely to develop disability over an eight-year period. Mobility was also related to enjoyment of life. This study does not prove that physical problems are caused by less enjoyment of life, but suggests a relationship. There is substantial evidence that genetics play a big role in happiness, according to Nancy Segal, psychologist at California State University, Fullerton, and author of "Born Together – Reared Apart." Research has shown that identical twins tend to have a similar level of happiness, more so than fraternal twins. And in identical twins, one twin's happiness is a better predictor of the other twin's current or future happiness than educational achievement or income, Segal said.

Summary

The passage explores the concept of happiness, its impact on well-being, and the factors influencing it. Happiness, though challenging to define precisely, is universally desired. Research indicates that genetics significantly affect subjective well-being, potentially predisposing some individuals to lower happiness levels. Environmental factors like stress and tragedies also influence emotional health. Managing emotions and maintaining a sense of purpose are vital for physical and mental health. Studies link psychological well-being, such as happiness and optimism, with lower risks of cardiovascular disease and healthier lifestyles. Optimistic individuals often adopt good habits, which benefit physical health. However, while associations between happiness and health are evident, direct causation remains unproven. Genetics play a substantial role in happiness, as seen in studies on identical twins, suggesting a biological basis for emotional states.

The tone of the passage is informative and analytical, with a touch of optimism. It adopts a neutral and objective stance, presenting scientific studies and expert insights to explain the interplay between happiness, genetics, and health.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
What evidence suggests a genetic role in happiness?

a) Fraternal twins often have similar happiness levels.
b) Identical twins show closer happiness levels than fraternal twins.
c) Happiness is more strongly linked to income and education than genetics.
d) Environmental factors always outweigh genetic factors in determining happiness.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
What does the study published in the journal Psychological Bulletin suggest?

a) Happiness directly prevents cardiovascular diseases.
b) Physical activity and diet are the only predictors of cardiovascular health.
c) Genetics have a stronger influence on happiness than lifestyle habits.
d) Positive psychological attributes are associated with a lowered risk of cardiovascular disease.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
What did the study in the Canadian Medical Association Journal find about enjoyment of life?

a) It has no measurable effect on physical health.
b) Greater enjoyment of life leads to a longer lifespan in people over 60.
c) Reduced enjoyment of life is associated with higher rates of disability in older adults.
d) Physical mobility is not related to enjoyment of life in older people.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Laziness isn’t why you procrastinate.

If you find yourself caught in a relentless cycle of procrastination, guilt, and chaos, you might wonder, "Why am I so lazy?" or "Why can’t I get my act together?" However, according to Jenny Yip, a clinical psychologist and executive director of the Little Thinkers Center in Los Angeles, laziness isn’t typically the cause of procrastination. Yip explains, “Laziness means having no desire even to think about something. Procrastination, on the other hand, stems from the discomfort of thinking about the task, making it difficult to complete.” Understanding the root cause of procrastination and learning strategies to address it are essential for change. Psychologist Linda Sapadin offers insights into procrastination through her book, How to Beat Procrastination in the Digital Age, which identifies various procrastination styles, such as the perfectionist, the dreamer, the worrier, and the defier. While these categories are not formal diagnoses or research-backed, they provide psychological explanations for procrastination, says Yip, who is also a clinical assistant professor of psychiatry at the University of Southern California’s Keck School of Medicine.

Procrastination can lead to practical setbacks like falling behind at work, failing to meet personal goals, or neglecting tasks on a to-do list. It can also take a toll on mental and emotional well-being, contributing to depression, anxiety, stress, poor sleep, inactivity, loneliness, and financial struggles. A study of over 3,500 college students conducted in January highlighted these effects. "In America, where self-worth is often tied to productivity and accomplishments, not being able to perform can feel deeply shameful," said Vara Saripalli, a Chicago-based clinical psychologist. "It can leave individuals feeling defeated and questioning the purpose of trying." While identifying the reason behind procrastination fosters self-awareness, developing effective strategies to overcome it is crucial. "Without strategies, we tend to repeat the same behaviors," Saripalli explained. "The approach to overcoming procrastination depends on the role it plays in your life." Yip notes that many procrastinators are perfectionists. "Perfectionists require everything to be flawless, which can make tasks feel overwhelmingly difficult. Without a clear plan, they may feel stuck."

Similarly, worriers often struggle with indecision, seeking constant advice or reassurance before taking action. Resistant to change, they prefer familiar routines. Both groups may delay tasks due to fear of failure or criticism, according to Itamar Shatz, a researcher at the University of Cambridge and creator of the website Solving Procrastination. To counter these tendencies, Shatz advises challenging perfectionistic beliefs and replacing them with more realistic expectations. “Set standards that are good enough, and allow yourself to make mistakes,” he suggests. Avoid all-or-nothing thinking and establish time limits for tasks, ensuring you stick to them even if things don’t go perfectly.

Question 4:
What does the study involving over 3,500 college students suggest about the effects of procrastination?

a) Procrastination primarily affects productivity but has little impact on mental health.
b) It is linked to financial struggles, stress, and social inactivity.
c) Students who procrastinate are more likely to perform better under pressure.
d) Procrastination is a behavior unrelated to depression or anxiety.
e) None of the above

Question 5
What is a potential emotional consequence of procrastination in the American context, according to Vara Saripalli?

a) It increases resilience by promoting self-awareness.
b) It leads to defiance against external expectations.
c) It creates shame due to societal emphasis on productivity.
d) It fosters independence by reducing reliance on deadlines.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

Precis writing:

Original Text: In recent years, the world has witnessed an exponential rise in the use of digital technologies, marking a fundamental shift in how people communicate, work, and interact with the world around them. Devices such as smartphones, laptops, and tablets have become integral to daily life, allowing individuals to stay connected, access information, and carry out tasks with unprecedented ease. Social media platforms, in particular, have revolutionized how people share information, form relationships, and express opinions. The proliferation of these technologies has undeniably brought numerous benefits, including greater convenience, new avenues for business growth, and enhanced educational opportunities for students and professionals alike. However, the rapid rise of digital technologies has also brought with it a series of challenges and concerns.

The constant connection to devices and social media has raised alarms about its impact on mental health, particularly regarding issues like addiction, anxiety, and the erosion of privacy. Studies have shown that excessive screen time can disrupt sleep patterns, contribute to feelings of isolation, and negatively affect attention spans. Furthermore, the rapid pace of technological advancements has led to a growing digital divide. While many individuals enjoy the benefits of digital innovation, there remains a significant portion of the global population that lacks access to the necessary resources, skills, or infrastructure to take advantage of these technologies. The digital divide is particularly evident in developing countries, where access to reliable internet and modern devices is often limited. This disparity has led to concerns about widening inequality, as those who are unable to engage with the digital world are increasingly left behind in terms of education, employment opportunities, and access to essential services. In light of these issues, there has been a growing call for governments, businesses, and educational institutions to invest in digital literacy programs. By improving access to digital tools and education, it is hoped that more people can fully participate in the digital revolution and bridge the gap between those who have access to technology and those who do not.

<u>Precis:</u> The rise of digital technologies, including smartphones, laptops, and social media platforms, has fundamentally transformed how people communicate, work, and access information. These advancements have brought benefits such as increased convenience, business opportunities, and enhanced education. However, concerns about mental health, such as addiction and privacy issues, have emerged due to constant device usage. Additionally, the rapid technological development has created a digital divide, especially in developing countries where access to technology is limited. This disparity has raised issues of inequality in education, employment, and access to services. To address this, there are calls for governments and businesses to invest in digital literacy programs to ensure broader participation in the digital age.

- **Write an email to an organization requesting a collaboration opportunity.**

To: Recipient email address
Subject: Request for Collaboration Opportunity

Dear [Recipient's Name],

I hope this email finds you well. My name is [Your Name], and I represent [Your Organization's Name]. We specialize in [briefly describe your organization's services or products], and we have been following your organization’s work with great interest.

We believe that a collaboration between our organizations could be mutually beneficial, and we are eager to explore the possibility of working together.

Specifically, we are interested in [mention the type of collaboration you're seeking, such as joint events, co-branded initiatives, or sharing expertise].

We would love the opportunity to discuss how we could align our goals and create a partnership that adds value to both organizations. Please let us know a convenient time for a meeting or a call to further explore this opportunity.

Thank you for considering this request. We look forward to the possibility of collaborating with your team.

Best regards,
[Your Full Name]
[Your Job Title]
[Your Organization's Name]

Match the column

1. Chance one's arm	A. To describe or do something exactly right
2. Dead in the water	B. To succeed or fail entirely by one's own efforts
3. Hit the nail on the head	C. To take a risk in the hope of achieving success
4. Sink or swim	D. Functions perfectly
5. Works like a charm	E. Completely stalled or unable to progress

Answer:

1-c

2-e

3-a

4-b

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Indecision:
2. Flawless:
3. Perceive:
4. Defier:
5. Impairment:
6. Relentless:
7. Parleys:
8. Acrimonious:
9. Annihilation:
10. Endeavor:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage states that research has shown identical twins tend to have similar levels of happiness, more so than fraternal twins, which indicates a genetic influence on happiness.

Reference:

“Research has shown that identical twins tend to have a similar level of happiness, more so than fraternal twins.”

Incorrect Options:

a) Fraternal twins do not show the same level of happiness as identical twins.

c) Income and education are mentioned but are less predictive than genetics.

d) The passage highlights a significant genetic role, even when environmental factors are considered.

2.

Ans: d

Explanation:

The study reviewed more than 200 studies and found a connection between attributes like happiness, optimism, and life satisfaction and a lower risk of cardiovascular disease.

Reference:

“A 2012 review of more than 200 studies found a connection between positive psychological attributes, such as happiness, optimism and life satisfaction, and a lowered risk of cardiovascular disease.”

Incorrect Options:

a) The study discusses associations, not direct prevention.
b) Diet and physical activity are contributors but not the sole predictors mentioned.
c) Genetics’ influence on happiness is discussed separately.

3.

Ans: c

Explanation:

The study highlighted that older adults who reported enjoying life less were more likely to develop disabilities and showed a connection between life enjoyment and mobility.

Reference:

“A study in the Canadian Medical Association Journal found that people ages 60 and older who said they enjoyed life less were more likely to develop disability over an eight-year period. Mobility was also related to enjoyment of life.”

Incorrect Options:

a) The study found a measurable effect.
b) Lifespan extension is not mentioned.
d) Mobility was explicitly connected to enjoyment of life.

4.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The study highlights that procrastination impacts mental health (stress, depression), emotional well-being (loneliness), and practical aspects (financial struggles).

Reference:

“Procrastination can lead to practical setbacks like falling behind at work, failing to meet personal goals... contributing to depression, anxiety, stress, poor sleep, inactivity, loneliness, and financial struggles.”

5.

Ans: c

Explanation:

Saripalli notes that in American culture, where self-worth is tied to productivity, failing to perform can cause feelings of shame and defeat.

Reference:

“In America, where self-worth is often tied to productivity and accomplishments, not being able to perform can feel deeply shameful.”

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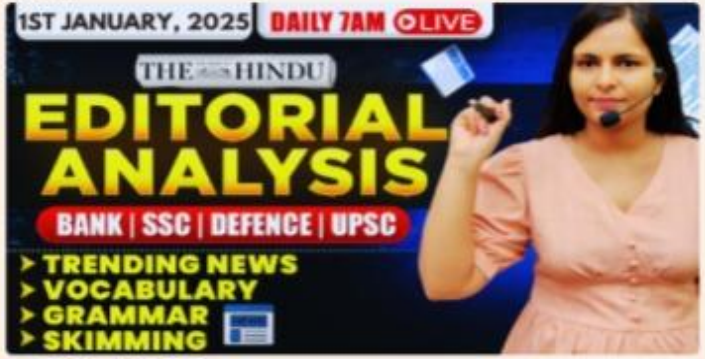

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Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

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